

PRODUCT-CATEGORY REVENUE ANALYSIS

Where the Revenue Actually Lives

1,000 startups on TrustMRR, broken down by product category — revenue pools, concentration risk, and exit-market signals — to find the fastest, most repeatable path to revenue.

TrustMRR 1,000-Row Dataset · Frozen 30 Jul 2026



A big, messy market — but revenue isn't spread evenly

726 of 1,000 tracked startups report a product category, spanning 29 distinct categories.



1,000

startups tracked

on TrustMRR



726

categorized companies

29 product categories



\$75.2M

combined 12-month
revenue

across categorized startups



76%

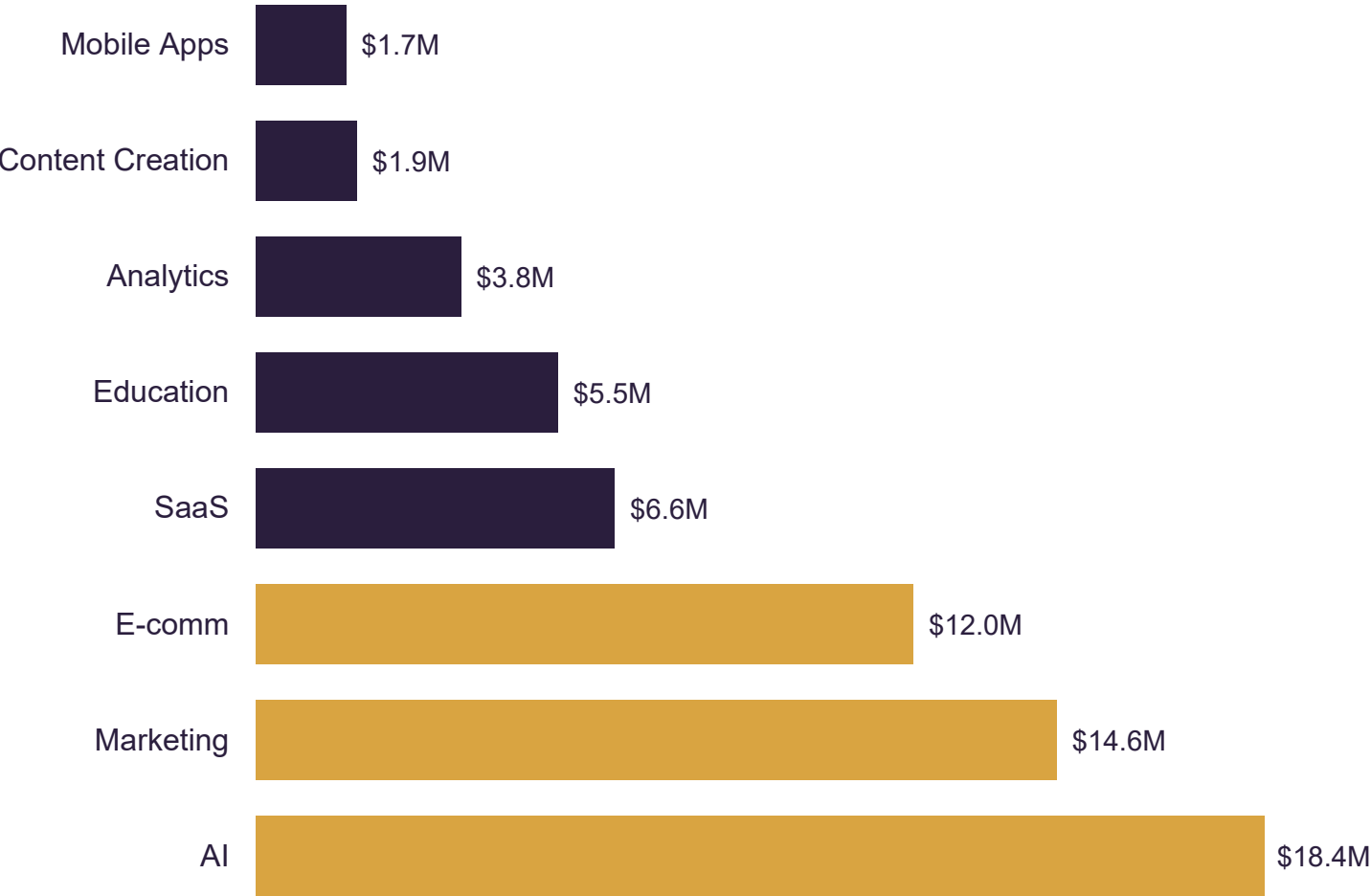
of all revenue

sits in just 5 categories

Insight The market isn't a level playing field. A handful of categories carry almost all the revenue — the rest of this deck is about finding which of them are actually a good bet to enter.

MARKET SIZE

Three categories already own 60% of all revenue



REVENUE SHARE

AI · Marketing · E-comm

60%

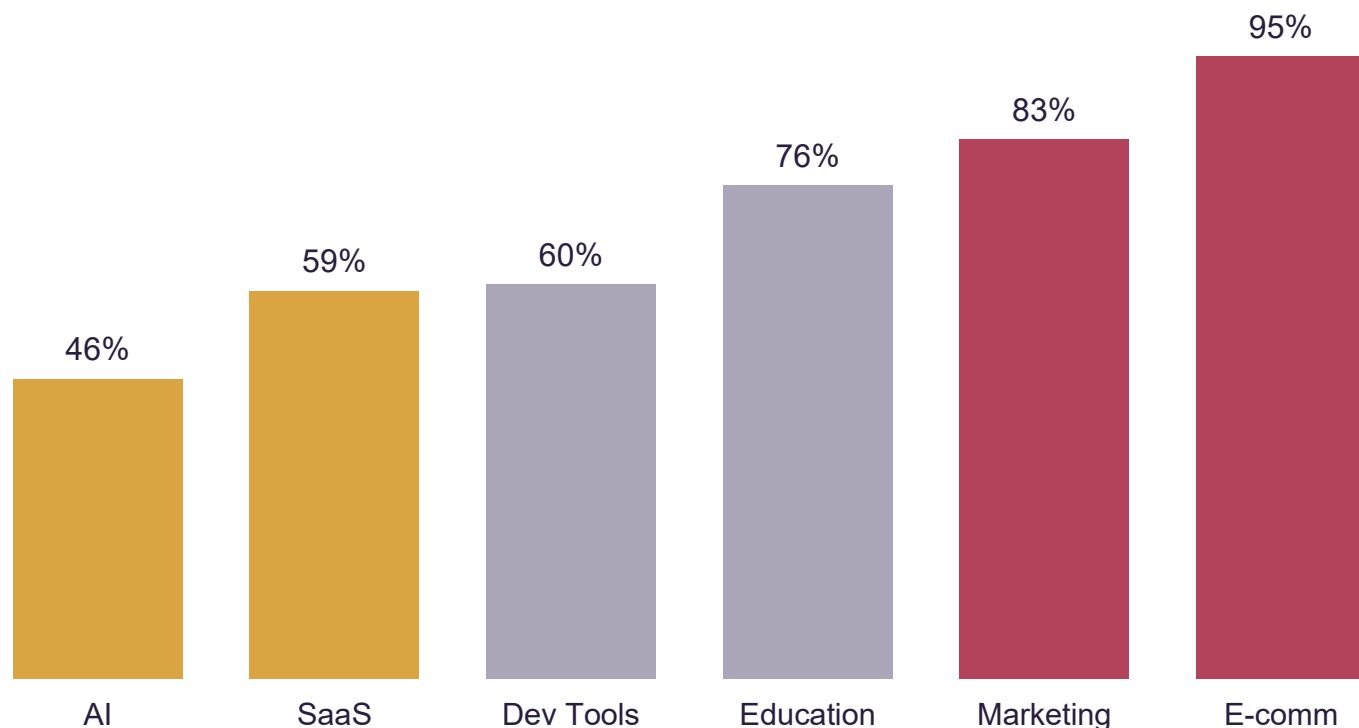
of the entire \$75.2M tracked revenue pool, from just 3 of 29 categories.

76%

comes from the top 5 (adding SaaS and Education) — the other 24 categories split the remaining quarter.

Being the biggest category isn't the same as being risky

Share of a category's revenue held by just its top 3 companies — the lower the number, the more the category's success is spread across many independent players.



197

AI companies in the dataset — 27% of every categorized startup — yet the top 3 hold under half the category's revenue.

Reading it right Low concentration means revenue was earned by many different companies, not one breakout. That's the signature of a repeatable playbook — a new entrant has real precedent to follow, not just one lucky winner to envy.

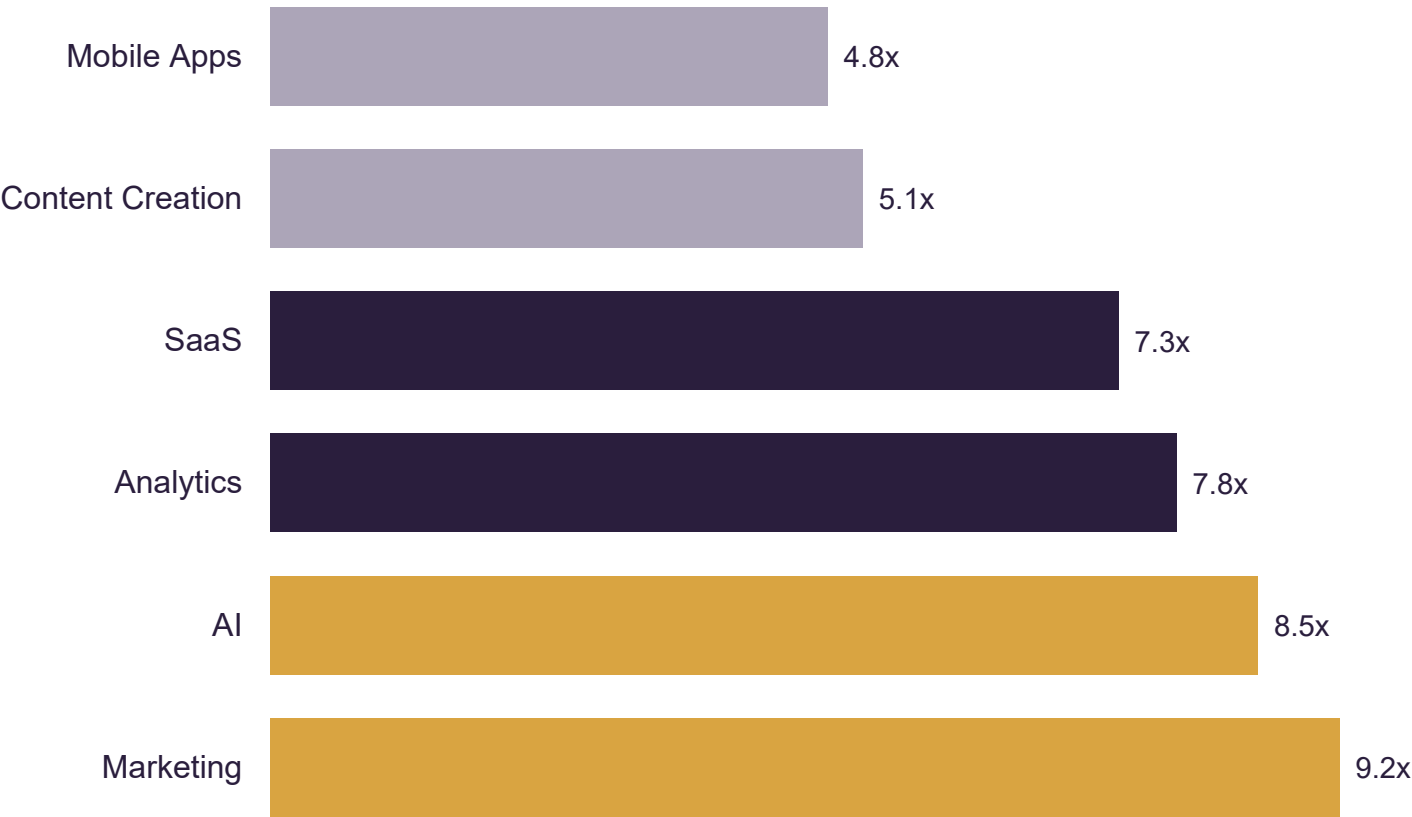
Marketing and E-comm pay more — but mostly to one winner

Average revenue per company looks strongest here. But combined with the concentration seen on the previous slide, that average is doing a lot of the talking.

CATEGORY	AVG. REVENUE / COMPANY	% OF COMPANIES > \$100K/YR	TOP-3 CONCENTRATION
E-comm	\$632.6K	26.3%	95.3% concentrated
Marketing	\$348.6K	26.2%	82.6% concentrated
SaaS	\$99.4K	19.7%	59.4% distributed
AI	\$93.5K	16.2%	45.9% distributed

Buyers back the same categories with real money

Average revenue multiple paid for businesses currently listed for sale (categories with 7+ listings, for a reliable read).



DEEPEST MARKET

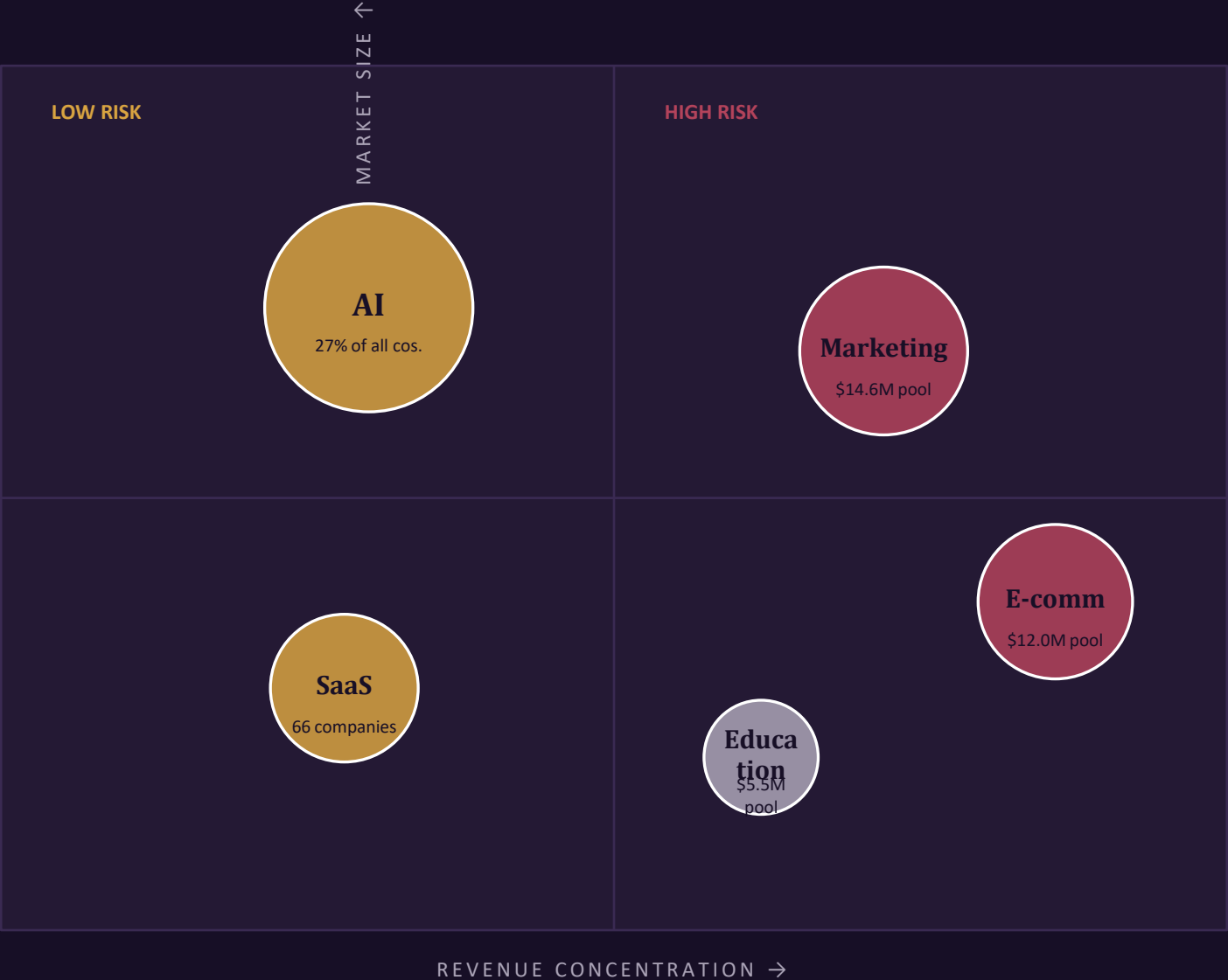
AI
54

businesses currently for sale at an average 8.5x revenue — 3x more listings than any other category. Liquidity, not just a headline number.

Marketing tops the multiple (9.2x) but on a thin sample of 9 listings — directionally consistent, not yet as proven.

CONCLUSION

AI and SaaS are the quickest, most repeatable paths to revenue



AI

ENTER

Largest revenue pool, most balanced (46% top-3), and by far the deepest exit market (54 listings, 8.5x). The clearest, most repeatable playbook.

SaaS

ENTER

Smaller checks, but 66 companies and 22 exit listings prove the recurring-revenue model works again and again — low-risk, steady climb.

Marketing & E-comm

SELECTIVE

Biggest average payouts and buyer multiples — but 83–95% of category revenue sits with one or two breakout companies. Only worth it with a real differentiator.